Vedant Kulkarni

EXTC

Company: ISS-STOXX

Job Profile: Data Quality

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 60k

CTC: 12.9 Base + 1.1 (PF and Gratuity) = 14L + Variable bonus (not mentioned yet)

Location: Nesco IT Park, Goregaon, Mumbai

Process Date: 5th Aug 25

Placement Process:

A total of 3 rounds were conducted -
1 Online Assessment Round
1 Tech Interview Round
1 HR Round.
All were conducted on the same day 5th Aug.
The CGPA Criteria was 8.5, later reduced to 8. It was further reduced to 7.5.
The Pre-Placement Talk was conducted online on 4th Aug.

1. **Online Assessment Round:**

The online assessment comprised 70 questions to be completed in 90 minutes. It was conducted via Google Forms at the college premises. The marking scheme awarded +1 for each correct answer and imposed a -0.25 penalty for incorrect ones.
The test was divided into four major sections: Java, Python, SQL, and Aptitude. Personally, I found the Aptitude section to be the most time-consuming. Unfortunately, I had less time left for it since I spent most of my time working through the first three sections.

2. **Technical Round 1:** [44 student appeared]

I was the first candidate to be interviewed in my panel, and my interview took place from 1:15 - 2:05 PM.

It began with my introduction, followed by an in-depth discussion about my resume. The questions covered my education, professional experience (internship), projects, and my interest in hackathons. The interviewer was polite and seemed genuinely interested in my projects and my Data Science degree from IIT Madras. This part lasted about 15–20 minutes.

Next came the coding round. I was given a database schema and asked three SQL questions based on it. The first two questions were easy, similar to this question: Average Selling Price, while the third was of medium difficulty similar to this question: Monthly Transactions 1. The topics included aggregate functions, joins, and subqueries. I'd recommend practicing the "Top 50 SQL Questions" from LeetCode for such rounds.

After that, the Data Science/Python coding round began. The interviewer provided a CSV file and asked me to use any notebook platform (Google Colab, Kaggle, or Jupyter Notebook). The questions were based on Pandas and NumPy, and I was asked to:

1. Comment on the data quality (e.g., detecting anomalies like invalid syntax in the email column or negative salaries).
2. Suggest how to remove or replace such data.

Go through this link to practice such questions: link

Towards the end, the interviewer asked how I would travel if I got the opportunity and also inquired about my family background.

I was able to answer all the questions confidently, explaining each concept in detail. Since I hadn't faked anything in my resume, discussing my projects and experiences in depth felt natural and rewarding.

3. **HR Round:** [15 students appeared]

Since I was the first to be interviewed in my panel, I had to wait quite a while for the results. My HR round selection was announced only around 6:00 PM, which meant there were about four long, uneventful hours in between. That wait honestly felt like the most boring part of the day.

In both my technical and HR rounds, the interviewers showed a lot of interest in my Data Science degree from IIT Madras. The HR round itself was a classic one, focused more on understanding me as a person, my aspirations, and how I saw my future with the company. Some of the questions included:

- What are your future growth plans?
- Do you plan to pursue higher studies?
- Where do you see yourself in the next few years?

The tone was conversational, and the interviewer seemed genuinely curious about my career direction and motivations. It was less about testing technical knowledge and more about seeing whether I would be a good cultural and long-term fit for the organization.

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Lastly, 12 students were selected out of 15, including me. 2 for Data quality, 2 for software testing, 8 for Software Engineering.

Useful Tips:

1. My first interview was for an SDE role at WorkIndia. I cleared all rounds and interviews, making no mistakes from my side, answering all questions, and solving all the given DSA questions in an optimized way, yet I was still not selected for the HR round. The thing I learned is that placement remains a game of luck given that you have all the skills.
2. Tailor your resume according to the job description of the company, and make sure to include all the skills and projects relevant to the role you're applying for. Check for grammatical errors, as they can instantly create a bad impression. Also, check your ATS score online (websites like Enhancv and Resume Worded can help). Most importantly, never fake information in your resume, if you're caught, it leaves a lasting negative impression. Be true and genuine.
3. Always attend the PPT, as information such as the company's values or history shared during it is often asked in the HR round.

4. If you have consistently worked hard for your placements from the start, then even with some hard luck, you will eventually end up with a good placement. Just don't give up, keep trying and believe in the work you've put in so far.
5. I have always loved participating in hackathons, and I would highly recommend you take part in such coding competitions to continuously learn and grow your skills. You can read my post about my hackathon experiences here - link.
6. Focus on basic concepts, practice DSA regularly, as it requires consistency. Revise DBMS theory and SQL questions (especially the Top 50 SQL questions from LeetCode), review OS and CN, and try to learn Java, as it is required by many companies.
7. Whenever you learn new skills, make sure to first understand the basics and build a strong foundation. For example, if you're interested in machine learning, start with linear algebra and statistics, and try to understand each algorithm mathematically, you'll enjoy it even more.
8. Try to make open-source contributions and participate in events like Hacktoberfest, GSoC, etc. For that, your skills are your weapon, build strong foundations in whatever you are learning, and then collaborate with other developers online to expand your connections.

Feel free to reach out in case of any queries : GitHub, LinkedIn